Supporting Information: Route-Aware Computational Selection of Redox Motifs for Preformed Polymers

Working draft: authorship and affiliations to be confirmed

Evidence revision: 22 October 2026

Internal working draft. This SI contains finite method controls and implementation checks. Pending scientific analyses remain explicit.

1 Benchmark intervals and post hoc reference diagnostics

The complete panel has 39 endpoints from 30 molecules and seven studies. Molecule-cluster 95% percentile bootstrap intervals are [0.213,0.286] V for MAE, [0.245,0.313] V for RMSE and [0.128,0.257] V for bias. Study-cluster intervals are [0.178,0.306], [0.211,0.325] and [0.053,0.285] V, respectively. Both use 2,000 replicates and seed 20261021. The seven study clusters have unequal sizes; their percentile intervals are weakly calibrated. Molecule resampling retains common study and family effects and is also not a prediction interval for a new molecule.

For each cross-validation fold, a constant residual offset is estimated only from training endpoints and subtracted from the held-out prediction. Molecule and study folds remove all endpoints of the held-out molecule or DOI. The two-offset model fits separate constants for first and second redox steps. These choices were motivated by inspection of the complete retrospective panel and are internal diagnostics, not an untouched external test. Relative potentials to TEMPO,

Table S1: Potential errors (V); primary unfitted statistics and internal offset diagnostics.

Holdout	Offset model	MAE	RMSE
None	Unfitted, primary	0.247	0.279
Endpoint	One constant	0.157	0.210
Molecule	One constant	0.158	0.211
Study	One constant	0.182	0.232
Endpoint	Separate step constants	0.106	0.166
Molecule	Separate step constants	0.106	0.166
Study	Separate step constants	0.124	0.177

N-ethylphenothiazine, N-methylphthalimide and 1,4-benzoquinone cancel the computed ferrocene term algebraically. Each diagnostic excludes every endpoint of its anchor molecule. The resulting error includes the organic anchor's own model and measurement errors. Agreement after reference cancellation therefore does not uniquely identify a ferrocene error.

The spin-only partition includes multiplicity but omits an additional ferrocenium orbital contribution. Matrix spectroscopy and multireference calculations support a degenerate electronic ground state.[1] An idealized additional twofold factor at 298.15 K would lower ferrocenium G by

0.0178 eV, lower the computed Fc absolute potential by 0.0178 V and increase target potentials versus Fc by 0.0178 V. This limiting calculation would worsen the positive first-step bias. It is not an applied correction: solvent, orbital, vibronic and Jahn–Teller splittings are unresolved.

2 Relative-basicity controls

The balanced reactions $B + DBUH^+ \rightarrow BH^+ + DBU$ avoid HCl, chloride and a free-proton reference. The exact pyridine, triethylamine and DBU identities match the revised author-maintained MeCN scale, with conjugate-acid pKa values 12.53, 18.83 and 24.31.[2, 3] Four new components and the two reused DBU components pass the same thermodynamic checks and an independent six-partition reconstruction. At 298.15 K, computed values are 71.82 and 32.68 kJ mol^{-1}, compared with pKa-derived values 67.24 and 31.28 kJ mol^{-1}; differences are +4.58 and +1.40 kJ mol^{-1}. These values use the exact SI eV-to-molar-energy factor. Historical source records use 96.485 kJ mol^{-1}/eV and are retained without replacement. Source temperature/activity qualifications remain open. This two-reaction control does not validate DIPEA, contact pairs or the complete grafting reaction and cannot assign the DBU/HCl discrepancy to a unique species.

3 Finite-polymer method controls

Twenty-six of the original twenty-seven electronic oligomer cases currently pass geometry and active-energy checks. The open PMDI trimer has recovered and passed independent force checks. The remaining stacked-start PMDI trimer is still being evaluated and remains outside completed comparisons. Construction and XYZ audits verify the intended open-chain topology. A trimer contains six backbone carbons, five backbone C–C bonds and two chain ends, rather than a triangular or cyclic backbone (Figure S1). Proximity of pendant rings does not change that covalent connectivity.

For the six-graph spacing control, all twelve electronic conformers qualify. The selected electronic nonadditivities are −10.98 and −14.50 kJ mol^{-1} for adjacent and one-spacer grafts, respectively. These refer to a matched empty-backbone minimum within the declared, limited sampling set. It demonstrates why a matched empty-backbone reference is necessary; it does not establish a universal distance trend.

All six selected-geometry native free energies now qualify, and both occupancy cycles close independently. The adjacent and one-spacer $\Delta\Delta G$ values are −5.15 and −11.23 kJ mol^{-1}, respectively (Figure S3). Changing the rotor cutoff among 25, 50 and 100 cm^{-1} gives ranges of −5.15 to −4.66 and −12.14 to −11.23 kJ mol^{-1}. These ranges describe partition sensitivity; they are not statistical confidence intervals or conformational ensemble uncertainties.

For DBU and separated ions, grafting site j onto an empty backbone gives −110.87 kJ mol^{-1} at site 3 and −103.41 kJ mol^{-1} at site 4. When site 2 is already grafted, these values become −116.02 and −114.64 kJ mol^{-1}. The contact-pair alternatives are −115.66 to −120.82 kJ mol^{-1} for site 3 and −108.21 to −119.43 kJ mol^{-1} for site 4. Both attachment orders obey the same nonadditivity cycle. Thus a prior graft changes the conditional thermodynamics in this finite control. A more negative second-attachment free energy is not automatically a desirable materials property when weak unwanted neighboring-site interactions are the objective.

Draft completion item: Resolve the final trimer slot and add representative redox-core and conformational sensitivity before making general polymer-design claims.

The intact-segment decomposition is complete for three sampled pairs using six frozen-fragment single-point calculations (Figure S4). Its partition separates interactions at the complex geometry from deformation relative to relaxed fragments. The interaction energies are −55.25, −44.30 and

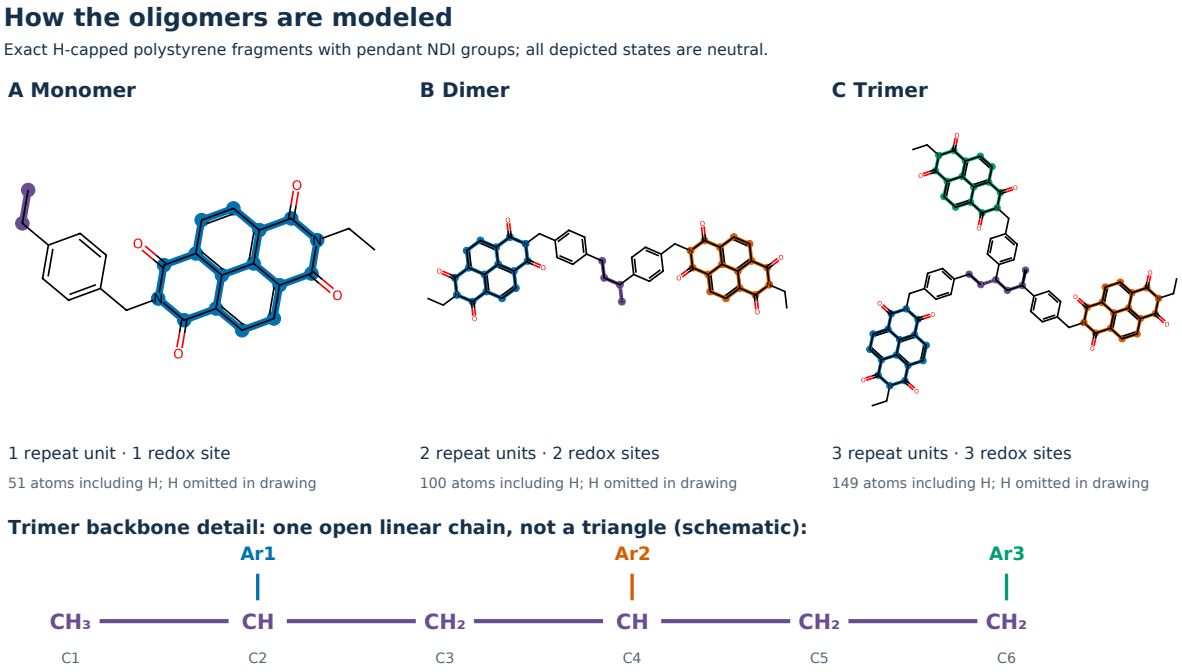


Figure S1: Exact finite-polymer construction used in the interaction controls. The highlighted open backbone distinguishes covalent connectivity from spatial contacts among pendant groups. Monomer, dimer and trimer models are dense local scenarios and do not represent an experimentally measured sequence or graft-loading distribution.

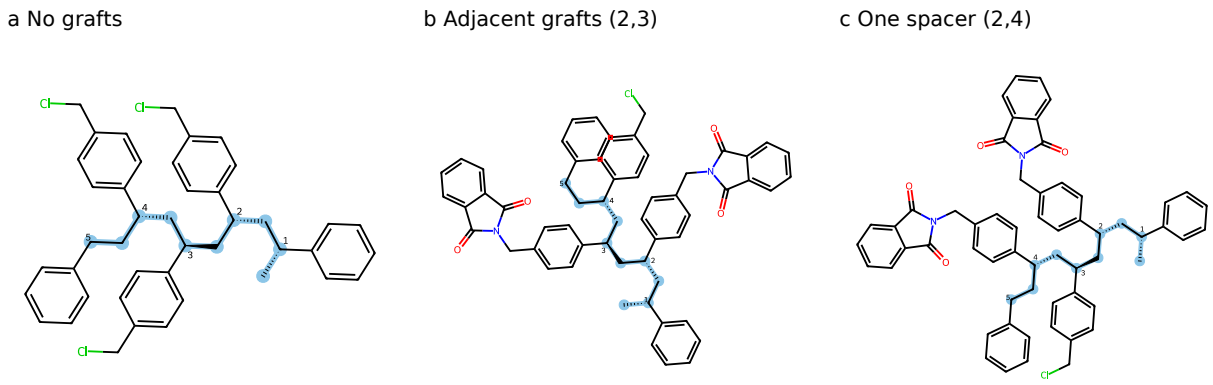


Figure S2: Exact five-repeat phthalimide graphs used in the occupancy cycles. Blue highlights the open ten-carbon backbone. Sites 1 and 5 are plain styrene padding; unoccupied reactive sites retain benzyl chloride. Numbers label repeat positions, and stereobonds retain the declared configuration. These are connectivity drawings, not sampled spatial conformations. Single-occupancy reference graphs are included in the evidence.

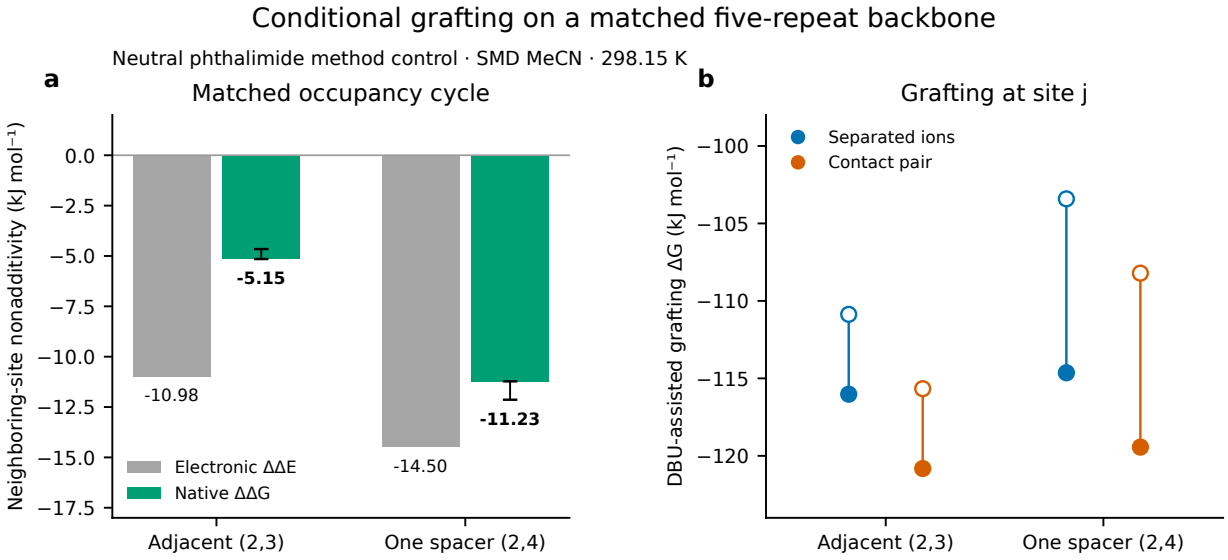


Figure S3: Conditional grafting in a matched five-repeat neutral phthalimide method control in MeCN at 298.15 K. Electronic and native free-energy nonadditivity are distinct. Whiskers vary only the rotor cutoff. Open and filled markers compare attachment at j without and with a graft at $i = 2$. All six selected geometries pass native QC, but the two conformers per graph do not establish an ensemble or a general spacing trend. Energies include backbone, conformational and solvent contributions.

-50.87 kJ mol^{-1}, with deformation terms $+0.56$, $+0.49$ and $+0.38$ kJ mol^{-1}, respectively. Small deformation terms describe proximity to the selected isolated-reference geometries; they do not demonstrate equilibrated segment conformations. The extent of complex relaxation and reference selection requires a separate audit. The resulting quantities remain electronic, uncorrected for basis-set superposition error and inclusive of backbone and cap contributions. No electron-transfer rate follows from their magnitude.

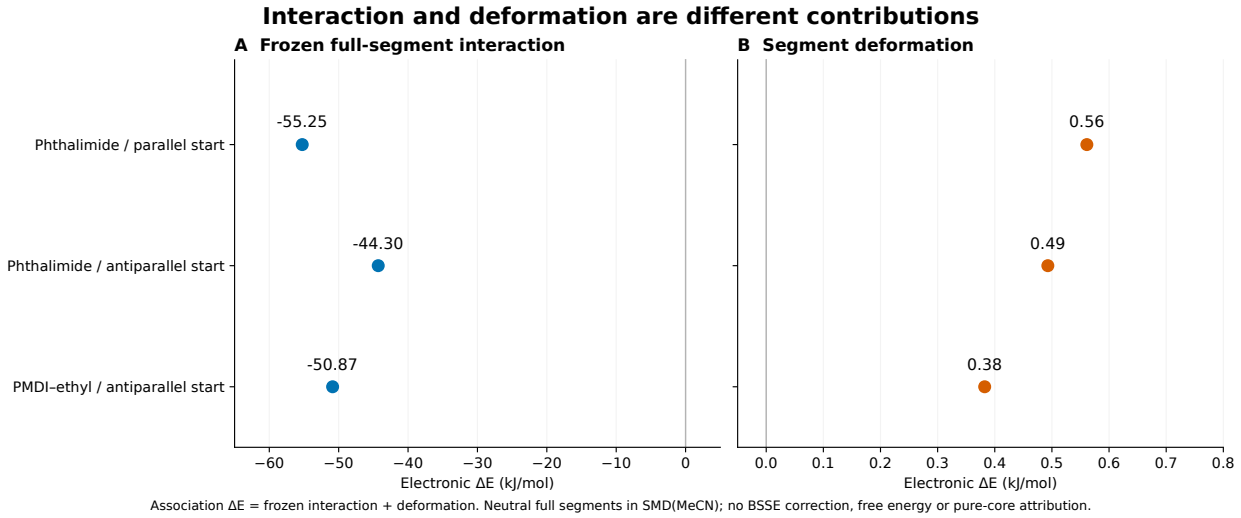


Figure S4: Electronic interaction/deformation partition for three intact segment pairs. Frozen fragments retain the complex geometry without bond cutting or new caps. The partition closes the association-energy cycle but is not a pure pendant-core interaction, a counterpoise-corrected energy or an association free energy.

4 Numerical implementation checks

Diagnostics exposed distinct numerical issues. At a checkpoint of the open PMDI trimer, a legacy solvent cavitation–dispersion–solvent-structure (CDS) force component disagrees with total-energy finite differences by approximately 1.81×10^{-4} hartree bohr^{-1} at the tested coordinate on both integration grids. This discrepancy is not resolved by electronic-grid refinement. Conservative CDS energy derivatives reproduce the tested total-energy differences; their step consistency is checked before use in a continuation. Adaptive refinement of unresolved CDS derivative components recovers the open-trimer optimization. At the returned geometry, independent total-energy derivatives at two step sizes and two tested coordinates agree within 4.2–5.0×10^{-7} hartree bohr^{-1}, below the unchanged 10^{-6} check threshold. This establishes an admitted stationary electronic geometry; no native-Hessian minimum or association free energy is inferred for that original oligomer case.

For the largest spacing Hessian, the original CDS finite-difference step produces a total asymmetry of 2.06×10^{-6}, exceeding the fixed 10^{-6} admission threshold. A separately qualified finer step reduces this to 2.05×10^{-8}. Additive reconstruction replays complete singlet and radical recomputations with maximum matrix differences of 1.33×10^{-11} and 2.83×10^{-9} atomic units, and thermal differences below 1.2×10^{-8} eV. The recovered target then passes the ordinary native gates, with a lowest internal frequency of $+7.23$ cm^{-1}. These are execution-equivalence results, not a relaxation of physical QC or a high-level validation of grafting energetics.

5 Execution and restart controls

A synthetic control packs one million distinct tasks into one thousand chunks in 75.9 s with a measured preparation peak RSS of 67.2 MiB. Eight workers on two hosts execute the synthetic tasks over a 9.58 s span, excluding packing and startup. Independent arithmetic checks find zero discrepancies. This timing characterizes scheduling and storage, not chemical enumeration, conformer search or DFT throughput.

Separately, all 837 molecular descriptor outputs agree with serial definitions. In the shared-filesystem recovery experiment, 32 real design recipes deduplicate to 17 exact molecular tasks. A worker on one host exits abruptly after four checkpointed tasks; owner verification on that host precedes recovery. A second host completes the remaining thirteen tasks without repeating the four checked tasks. All resumed outputs match uninterrupted execution and a separate serial replay. This experiment tests descriptor-stage recovery. A distinct quantum interruption experiment is described below; neither establishes million-molecule quantum throughput. A seeded randomized concurrency experiment executes the same 837 exact designs fifteen times, with three repeats per condition and eight tasks per chunk. All 12,555 molecular comparisons match the independent serial definition. Median launch-to-observed completion times are 4.436, 3.147, 2.680 and 2.497 s for one, two, four and eight CPU workers on one host; eight workers across two hosts require 2.585 s (Figure S5). These times include node preflight, SSH, scorer initialization, execution and at most 0.1 s of observation polling; preparation is separate. All requested workers finish, but only seven of eight execute chunks in one single-host repeat. The diminishing returns of this small library do not determine an optimal concurrency for larger or more expensive stages.

A separate sparse Git checkout and newly installed Python 3.11 CPU environment reproduce the declared 32-recipe / 17-design example with system and user site packages disabled. The project loads from that checkout and scientific dependencies load from the new environment. Serial descriptor replay, exact-route holds and the regenerated conditional-grafting table all match; rendered RGB pixels of the figure are identical. This qualifies a small CPU reproduction using curated scientific data. It does not recompute the underlying quantum energies or qualify the complete CUDA environment.

Draft completion item: Complete conformer-stage adapters, broader quantum recovery controls and accessible archival packaging. Keep stage-specific throughput separate from scientific accuracy.

5.1 Actual quantum interruption and recovery

Two rigid controls, formaldehyde (singlet) and methyl radical (doublet), compare uninterrupted calculations with a fresh process resumed after an intentional exit following three durable gradient evaluations. The exit code is 87; process and start identity confirm termination before resubmission. The saved geometry is unqualified until optimization, active electronic energy, DFT Hessian, projected partition, topology and spin checks pass normally. Acceptance tolerances were 10^{-5} eV for electronic energy, 10^{-4} eV for free energy, 10^{-3} Å aligned RMSD and 0.5 cm^{-1} for internal frequencies. Singlet differences are 4.03×10^{-6} eV, 1.26×10^{-5} eV, 6.87×10^{-6} Å and 0.0685 cm^{-1}; doublet differences are 4.00×10^{-6} eV, 1.11×10^{-6} eV, 3.45×10^{-5} Å and 0.0264 cm^{-1}. Four final partitions were independently reconstructed. This verifies restart equivalence for these two controls, not flexible-polymer sampling or chemical accuracy.

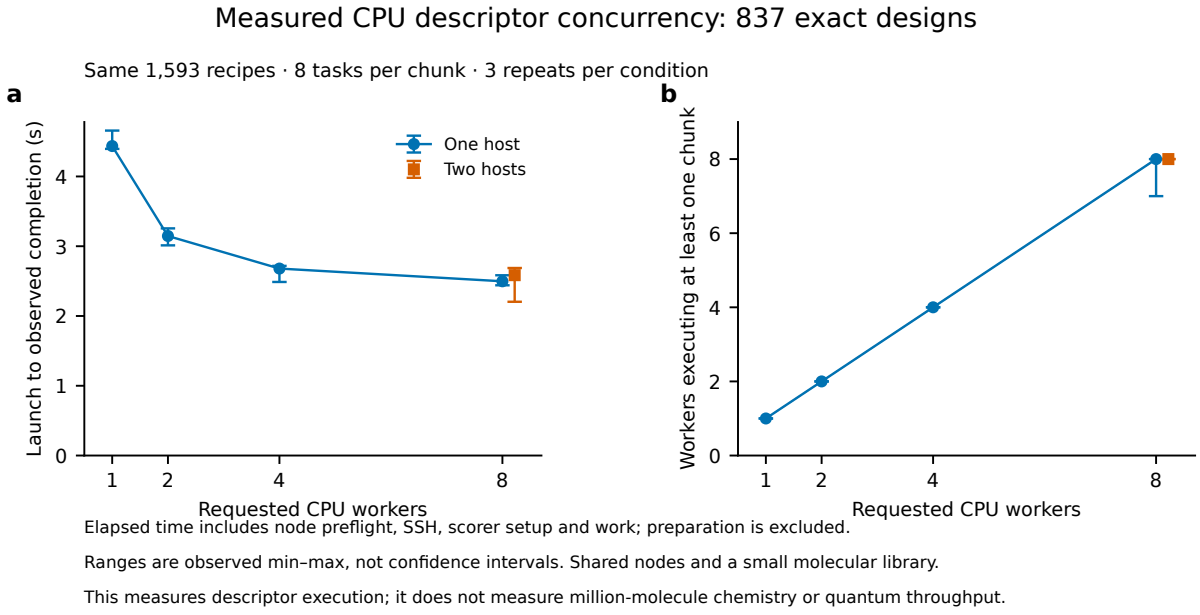


Figure S5: Measured CPU descriptor concurrency for the same 837 exact designs. Three randomized repeats per condition retain every result. Ranges are observed minima and maxima, not confidence intervals. Launch, preflight and scorer overhead are included; preparation is separate. Requested workers and workers executing at least one chunk are distinct. This shared-node, small-library experiment does not measure million-molecule chemistry or quantum throughput.

Table S2: Terms used in evidence files and their interpretation.

Term	Meaning
Exact design	A specified precursor/product graph and mapped attachment bond; generating recipes can deduplicate to the same design.
Checked or qualified	The checks required for the named field passed; this is not experimental validation.
Native free energy	Active electronic energy plus the projected geometry-level DFT nuclear partition and declared spin partition.
Frozen snapshot	An immutable, hash-verified copy of specified evidence; newer live results require a new snapshot.
Proceed / hold / exclude	Route decisions within the stated evidence scope; hold means required exact-route evidence is incomplete.
Endpoint	One sourced redox-potential comparison, with exact molecular identity, state pair and reference convention.
Pose	One conformational starting geometry; the final optimized contact class is checked separately.

6 Evidence terminology

References

[1] Jan Fulara, Karol Filipkowski, and John P. Maier. Electronic Transition of Ferrocenium: Neon Matrix and CASPT2 Studies. *The Journal of Physical Chemistry C*, 121:10694–10697, 2017. doi: 10.1021/acs.jpcc.6b10391.

[2] Sofja Tshepelevitsh, Agnes Kütt, Märt Lõkov, Ivari Kaljurand, Jaan Saame, Agnes Heering, Paul G. Plieger, Robert Vianello, and Ivo Leito. On the basicity of organic bases in different media. *European Journal of Organic Chemistry*, 2019:6735–6748, 2019. doi: 10.1002/ejoc.201900956.

[3] University of Tartu, Chair of Analytical Chemistry. Author-maintained basicity collection and recommended acid table. https://analytical.chem.ut.ee/databases/pka-values/. Accessed 22 October 2026. Acid table: https://analytical.chem.ut.ee/HA_UT/pKa_Table_Water_Acetonitrile_DCE_Gas_Phase.pdf.